



FIRST LOOK

After you read this, go to thinkdigit.com/d/corei7_980X for more information on this spanking new CPU

Intel i7 980 Extreme

The first of its kind

In this day and age of dual and quad cores, hex core is not a phrase you'd have heard much. That's because this is the first 6-core desktop solution out there. Behold, Intel's latest brainchild — the 980 Extreme — 6 cores with hyperthreading, running at 3.33 GHz, and based on a shiny new 32nm fabrication process. We received a review sample that shipped with a huge, (by Intel standards), heat-pipe-based cooling solution that has a pretty neat retention mechanism along with a backplate — something that we've not seen on stock cooling solutions. Even though this chip is 32nm, it isn't necessarily cooler than the Core i7 975 Extreme,

owing to the extra cores that nullify the thermal advantage a fab shrink would theoretically bring about. We noticed temperatures crossed 55 degrees Celsius on load, something that didn't happen on the 975 Extreme. CPU-Z shows the L2 cache to be 1.5 MB which is strange since the quad-core Core i7 features a 2 MB cache. The L3 cache is 12 MB i.e. 2 MB per core, unchanged from the earlier Nehalems.

That aside, the benchmarks speak for themselves and the 980 Extreme is a fire breather in terms of performance, winning benchmark competitions with ease. Applications that do not properly utilise more than four cores will not see a per-

formance gain, heavily multi-threaded applications will benefit. Most games, for example, will not see an increase in fps, but future titles might, given that parallelism is the new playfield for performance. 3D Mark Vantage kept crashing on our 980 Extreme, so that was the only benchmark that we didn't use. Wprime 2.0 is a whole 1.892 seconds faster and took 5.381 seconds to complete.



Intel's bundled heatsink — mean!

The Core i7 975 Extreme, the previous fastest CPU managed 7.273 seconds. Our rendering test saw Maya 8.0 take just 20 seconds, a whole nine

seconds faster. DivX Encoder 7 took around the same time to complete — no change, but Handbrake that is optimised for more than four cores took 82.3 seconds as opposed to 104.1 seconds to encode a 100 MB .VOB file to .MP4, so the extra two cores are making a sizeable difference.

We feel *Tales of Valor* responds to clock speeds and is taking advantage of Turbo Mode on the Core i7 975 Extreme. Things are promising if you look at Crysis Warhead — the performance delta is huge — 57 fps more, meaning the game is making full use of the extra cores — a trend that will only continue. The pricing for this monster of a CPU is still not known, since it's not officially available here, but we expect it to be around the Rs. 50,000 mark — which is more than entire gaming rigs. That being said, if you are interested in having a shot at setting benchmarking records, this is the CPU for you.

Specifications

Core speed: 3.33 GHz, L1 cache: 384 KB, L2 cache: 1536 KB L3 cache: 12 MB, Platform: LGA 1366, Number of Cores: 6 with Hyperthreading

Contact

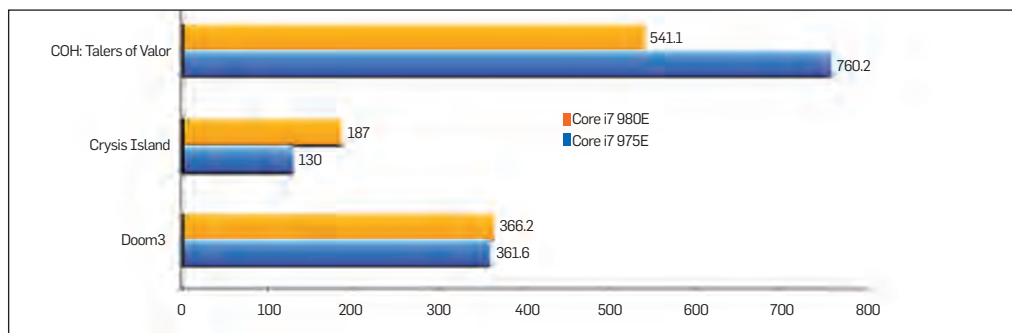
Intel Corp

Phone: 1-800-425 4999

Email: apacsupport@mailbox.intel.com

Web site: www.intel.com/in

Price: Rs. 50,000 (approx)



7.5/10

Features..... 8.5
Performance 9
Value 5.5